

Activity 3 -Research Methodology

Index No: 215111T

Identify a practical issue and mention what is the most suitable research type that can be used to provide a solution to the mentioned issue.

- Issue: The declining attention span among university students due to increased use of digital devices and social media.

The issue of declining attention span among university students, largely influenced by the increasing use of digital devices and social media, is of considerable significance in the academic context. Sustained attention is a critical factor in effective learning, comprehension, and knowledge retention, and its reduction directly impacts academic performance. Beyond grades, diminished attention also affects classroom engagement, participation in collaborative activities, and the overall quality of the learning experience.

- Research approach: Mixed Research with a longitudinal approach

Justification:

- Since the problem deals with human behavior and learning patterns, qualitative research (e.g., interviews, focus groups) will help in understanding the underlying reasons, perceptions, and experiences of students.
- At the same time, quantitative research (e.g., surveys, performance analytics, statistical tests) will provide measurable data on study habits, grades, and time spent on digital devices.
- Using a longitudinal research design will allow the tracking of changes in attention span and performance over a period

of time rather than relying on one-time observations, thus providing more reliable insights.